

Erasmian Koine Greek Alphabet

Companion chart to Everyday Koine. Seminary / academic Erasmian — distinct letter sounds for spelling, not first-century speech.

Letters

Letter	Name	Sound	Written
A α	alpha	a as in father	a
B β	beta	b	b
Γ γ	gamma	g as in got	g
Δ δ	delta	d	d
E ε	epsilon	e as in met	e
Z ζ	zeta	dz as in adze	z
H η	eta	e as in obey (long)	ē
Θ θ	theta	th as in thing	th
I ι	iota	i as in pit / machine	i
K κ	kappa	k	k
Λ λ	lambda	l	l
M μ	mu	m	m
N ν	nu	n	n
Ξ ξ	xi	x as in axe	x
O ο	omicron	o as in not	o
Π π	pi	p	p
P ρ	rho	r (trilled)	r
Σ σ ς	sigma	s	s
T τ	tau	t	t
Υ υ	upsilon	u as in lute / put	u
Φ φ	phi	ph as in phone	ph
Χ χ	chi	ch as in loch	ch
Ψ ψ	psi	ps as in lips	ps
Ω ω	omega	o as in tone (long)	ō

Diphthongs

Spelling	Made of	Sound
αι	alpha + iota	eye
ει	epsilon + iota	ay
οι	omicron + iota	oy
υι	upsilon + iota	wee
αυ	alpha + upsilon	ow
ευ	epsilon + upsilon	ew
ηυ	eta + upsilon	ew
ου	omicron + upsilon	oo

Gamma is ng before γ, κ, χ or ξ — ἄγγελος is ang-geh-los. The iota subscript (α ι η ω) does not change the sound. A rough breathing (᾿) adds an initial h; a smooth breathing (᾿) does not, and on an initial ρ the breathing is not sounded. Accents mark stress, not pitch.